Safe Manual Handling Illustration Brief

36 slide images for an interactive CPD module. The pictures in this brief are placeholder drawings generated in code. They show the composition and the teaching point for each slide; they are not the style target. We are commissioning finished artwork to replace them.

Deliverable	**36 images, JPG, 1500 × 1000 px (3:2), quality ~80, under 250 KB each**
File names	**Exactly as printed on each page, e.g. `29-the-lift.jpg`**
Also useful	**Layered source files and SVG, if the style allows**
Where they go	**`public/media/training/` on the module site**
Viewing size	**Roughly 420–620 px wide on screen; must read on a phone**

STYLE TARGET

Flat vector illustration with soft shading — the current trade-safety look: solid shapes, no outlines, restrained texture. Grown-up and matter-of-fact rather than cartoonish. The audience is site workers and their supervisors, so the people should look like people who do the work.

CAST AND SETTING

One recurring worker carries the module: mid-30s to mid-50s, hard hat, hi-vis vest with two reflective bands, work shirt, work trousers, work boots. Show a mix of people across the set — at least two women and a range of ages, builds and skin tones, with the same care taken over each. Every figure wears correct PPE in every frame, including the ones demonstrating the wrong technique: the mistake is the posture, never the kit.

Backgrounds are a soft grey site: a pale skyline, a crane or two, a ground band. Keep them faint. The figure and the load are the subject.

Working rules

PALETTE

	Hi-vis orange (hard hat, vest)	`#F1712F`		**Hard hat shade**	`#CF5620`
	Reflective band	`#F5C84C`		**Work shirt blue**	`#4A6B86`
	Trousers navy	`#2F4457`		**Boots tan**	`#B9884E`
	Skin base	`#F0C69F`		**Cardboard**	`#B08355`
	Background grey	`#E7E8EA`		**Ground grey**	`#CFD2D6`
	Site silhouette	`#D5D7DA`		**Ocean (labels)**	`#005BB3`
	Ruby (wrong / warning)	`#D8226C`		**Emerald (right)**	`#029456`

RIGHT AND WRONG

- Green circled tick marks correct technique; a ruby circled cross marks incorrect technique. Same size, same position rules, every time.
- Colour is never the only signal — the posture itself must make the difference obvious in greyscale.
- On a right/wrong pair, keep the worker, the load and the camera identical so only the technique changes.

LABELS

- Short chips (e.g. `DO NOT TWIST`) sit inside some images. Keep the wording exactly as specified — the slide text refers to it.
- Set chips in the module's heading face at a size that survives a 420 px render. Avoid long lines.
- No other text in the image. Everything else lives beside the picture as HTML, which keeps it translatable and screen-reader friendly.

FRAMING AND SAFE AREA

- Images are cropped to fill a 3:2 frame. Keep the subject clear of a 60 px margin on every edge.
- No important detail in the bottom-left corner: on narrow screens that area sits closest to the text.
- Design for a light background. Avoid white-on-white edges.

ACCURACY

- Every posture is teaching material. If a correct-technique frame is anatomically off, it teaches the wrong thing. Please pose or photograph reference.
- Loads should be plausibly heavy: a box the worker can get their arms around, on the ground or at bench height.
- Irish site context. No Hi-Vis branding, no real company logos, no recognisable real people or buildings, and nothing copied from existing safety posters.

REUSE

- Several slides share a composition (08 and 24; 11 and 16; 10 and 22; 18 and 28). Each still needs its own file, but they can be variations of one setup — the notes say where a difference matters.

01 Welcome

INTRODUCTION & LEGISLATION

`01-welcome.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Opening slide. Sets the scene and the tone: ordinary competent workers on an ordinary site.

COMPOSITION

Two workers on a site, one standing facing the viewer's left, one carrying a medium cardboard box at waist height. Faint site backdrop. Both in correct PPE.

NOTES

Neither worker is doing anything wrong — this is not a right/wrong slide. Relaxed posture, load held close.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Manual handling is part of nearly every job on a building site. Done badly, it is also one of the quickest ways to end up injured.
- This module takes about 20 minutes. It covers what the law expects, how to assess a lift, and the technique that keeps your back out of trouble.
- There are ten questions along the way. You need 8 out of 10 to pass.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

Two site workers, one carrying a box

02 What counts as manual handling

INTRODUCTION & LEGISLATION

`02-what-counts-as-manual-handling.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Defines manual handling: lifting, carrying, pushing, pulling, supporting.

COMPOSITION

Two vignettes side by side: left, a worker carrying a box; right, a worker pushing a loaded sack truck. Equal visual weight.

NOTES

The pair must read as 'both of these count'. No ticks or crosses.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- The Regulations define manual handling of loads as any transporting or supporting of a load by one or more employees.
- That includes lifting, putting down, pushing, pulling, carrying or moving a load.
- A load is not only a box. It can be a bag of sand, a length of timber, a tool, a wheelbarrow, a gas cylinder or a person.

> **If you move it with your body rather than a machine, it is manual handling.**

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker carrying a box beside a worker pushing a loaded trolley

03 Why it matters

INTRODUCTION & LEGISLATION

`03-why-it-matters.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

The human cost. Manual handling is the biggest single cause of reported injury in Ireland.

COMPOSITION

A single worker upright but wincing, one hand pressed to the lower back. A small pain motif (a jagged flash) at the lower spine, and a 'PAIN' label.

NOTES

Keep it serious, not comic. No blood, no hospital imagery, no exaggerated agony. Mid-shot.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Manual handling is the single biggest cause of workplace injury reported in Ireland.
- In 2022, manual handling accounted for 2,712 non-fatal injuries reported to the Health and Safety Authority: 30% of the total. Manual handling and falls together made up 55%.
- Back injuries are slow to heal, easy to repeat, and can follow you for the rest of your working life.

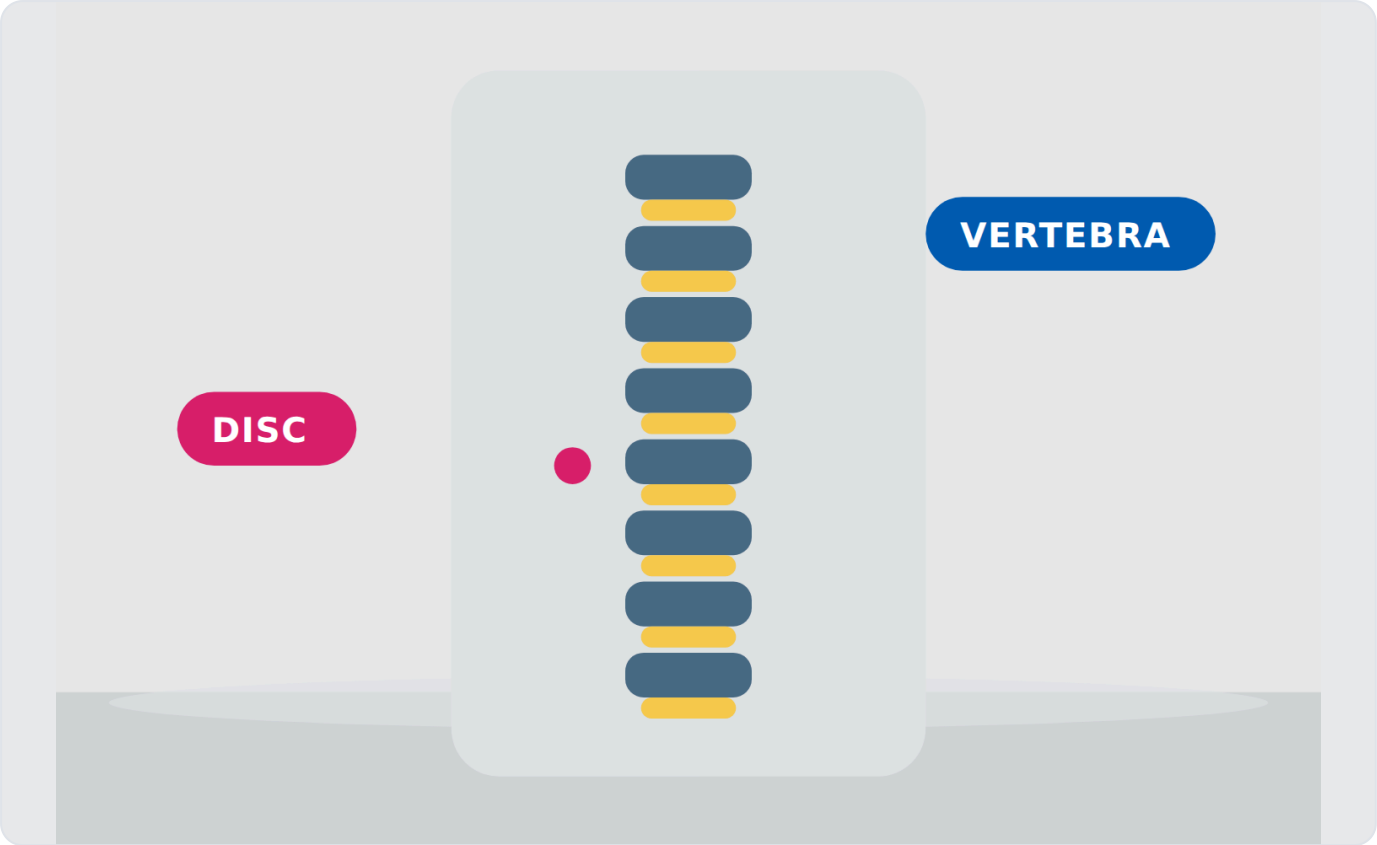
ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker holding their lower back in pain

04 How your back works

INTRODUCTION & LEGISLATION

`04-how-your-back-works.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Anatomy: vertebrae separated by discs, strongest in natural alignment.

COMPOSITION

Simplified diagram of a stack of 8 vertebrae with discs between them, one disc highlighted in red as the pressure point. Labels: DISC, VERTEBRA.

NOTES

Schematic, not medical-textbook realism. No full skeleton or body. Must be readable at 400px wide.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Your spine is a stack of bones called vertebrae, separated by soft discs that act as cushions.
- Muscles and ligaments hold the stack in line. The spine is strongest when it keeps its natural S-shape.
- Bending and twisting under load squeezes the discs unevenly. Do that often enough and the disc gives way.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

Diagram of vertebrae separated by discs, with one disc under strain

05 The law: the 2005 Act

INTRODUCTION & LEGISLATION

`05-the-law-act-2005.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

The Safety, Health and Welfare at Work Act 2005 sets employer and employee duties.

COMPOSITION

Two document covers side by side with a tick badge over them. Labels: ACT 2005 and REGS 2007.

NOTES

Generic documents. Do NOT reproduce a real HSA cover, State harp, crest or logo.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- The Safety, Health and Welfare at Work Act 2005 is the main piece of Irish safety law.
- It places a duty on employers to provide a safe place of work, safe systems of work, and the information, instruction, training and supervision needed to work safely.
- It also places duties on employees, which we cover in the next section.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

Two legal documents with a tick

06 The Regulations

INTRODUCTION & LEGISLATION

`06-the-regulations.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Chapter 4 of Part 2 of the 2007 General Application Regulations, and Schedule 3.

COMPOSITION

One document under a large magnifying glass, as if being examined closely.

NOTES

Same rule as above: invented cover, no real crests or publisher marks.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Manual handling is dealt with in Chapter 4 of Part 2 of the Safety, Health and Welfare at Work (General Application) Regulations 2007.
- The Regulations set out what the employer must do, and Schedule 3 lists the risk factors that a manual handling assessment has to consider.
- Those factors fall into five groups: the load, the physical effort, the working environment, the requirements of the activity, and the individual doing it.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A regulation document under a magnifying glass

07 Two ways injuries happen

INTRODUCTION & LEGISLATION

`07-two-ways-injuries-happen.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Sudden injury versus cumulative wear.

COMPOSITION

Two figures: one mid-stretch (recovering, looking after themselves), one standing normally. A tick badge between them.

NOTES

Alternative welcomed: a split composition — one side a single heavy snatch lift with a flash, the other the same small lift repeated three times, fading. If you draw that, keep it in one frame.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Sudden injuries happen in one movement: a heavy awkward lift, a slip mid-carry, a twist to put something down.
- Cumulative injuries build up over months of small, repeated strains that never quite get a chance to recover.
- Both can end in the same place: strains, sprains, or damage to a disc.

> **Anywhere in the musculoskeletal system can be injured, not just your lower back.**

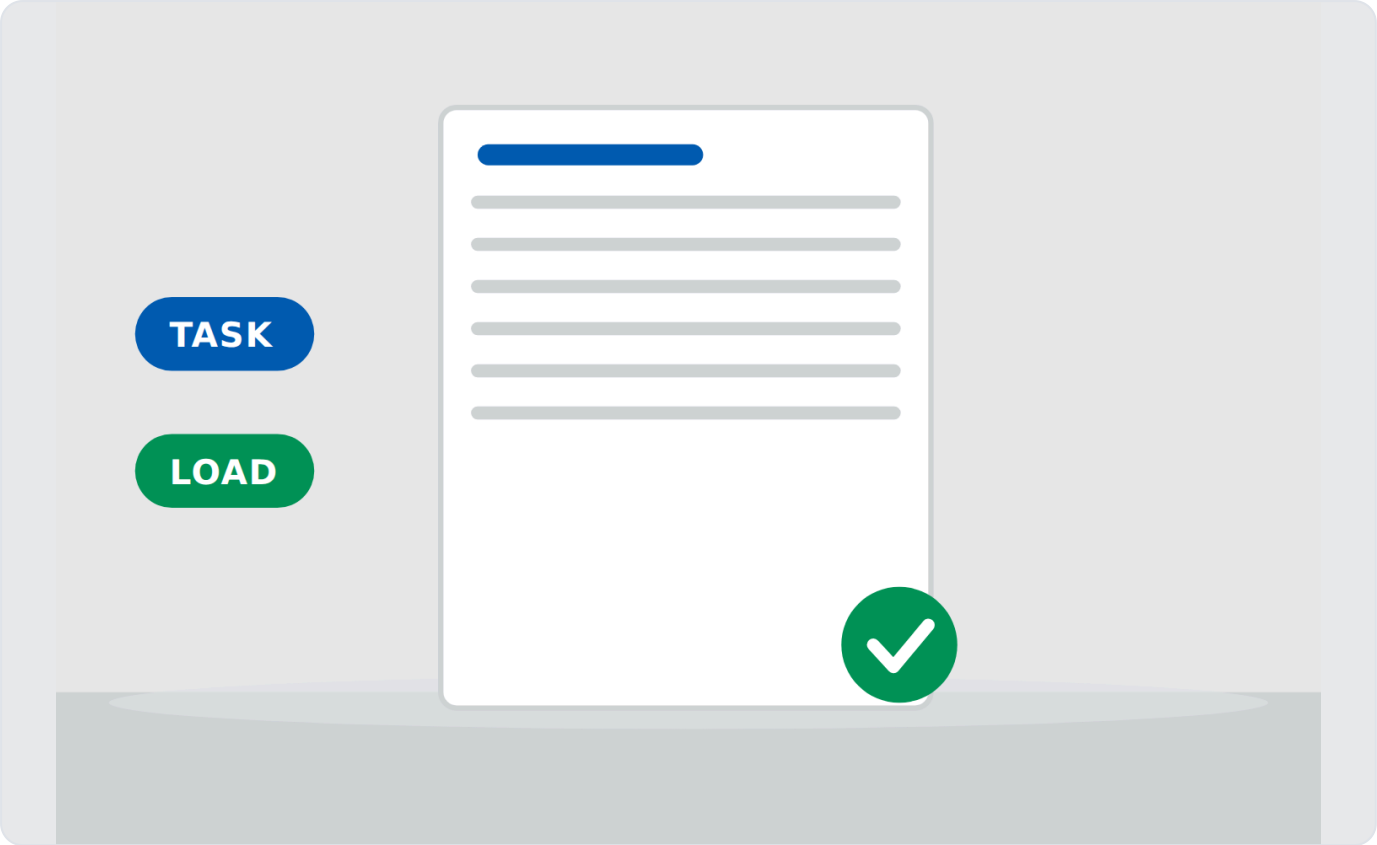
ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker stretching beside a worker standing upright

08 Section summary

INTRODUCTION & LEGISLATION

`08-summary-legislation.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Wrap-up of section 1.

COMPOSITION

A checklist sheet with three ticked lines and a tick badge. Two small chips: TASK, LOAD.

NOTES

Reusable summary image; three summary slides use the same kind of composition, so keep them distinguishable by the chips.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Manual handling covers lifting, carrying, pushing, pulling and supporting any load.
- It causes around 30% of reported non-fatal workplace injuries in Ireland.
- The rules come from the 2005 Act and Chapter 4 of Part 2 of the 2007 General Application Regulations.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A checklist with a tick

09 Avoid, assess, reduce

EMPLOYER & EMPLOYEE DUTIES

`09-avoid-assess-reduce.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

The employer's duties in order: avoid, then assess, then reduce.

COMPOSITION

Left: a worker stooping to lift a box, marked with a red cross. Right: the same load on a sack truck being pushed, marked with a green tick.

NOTES

The two halves must be instantly comparable: same box, same worker, same camera height.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- The employer’s duties run in a fixed order.
- First, avoid hazardous manual handling wherever it is reasonably practicable, by organising the work differently or using equipment.
- Where it cannot be avoided, assess the risk. Then reduce that risk as far as reasonably practicable.

> **Avoid first. A lift that never happens cannot hurt anybody.**

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A stooped lift marked with a red cross beside a loaded trolley marked with a green tick

10 Designing the lift out

EMPLOYER & EMPLOYEE DUTIES

`10-designing-the-lift-out.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Provide equipment so the lift never happens.

COMPOSITION

Three handling aids in a row: sack truck with a box, flat platform trolley with a box, and an overhead hoist hook.

NOTES

No people. Equipment should look like everyday Irish site kit, not warehouse robotics.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Deliver closer to the point of use, so loads travel less.
- Order materials in smaller units, or split a load before moving it.
- Provide trolleys, sack trucks, pallet trucks, hoists, telehandlers and roller tracks — and keep them where the work is.

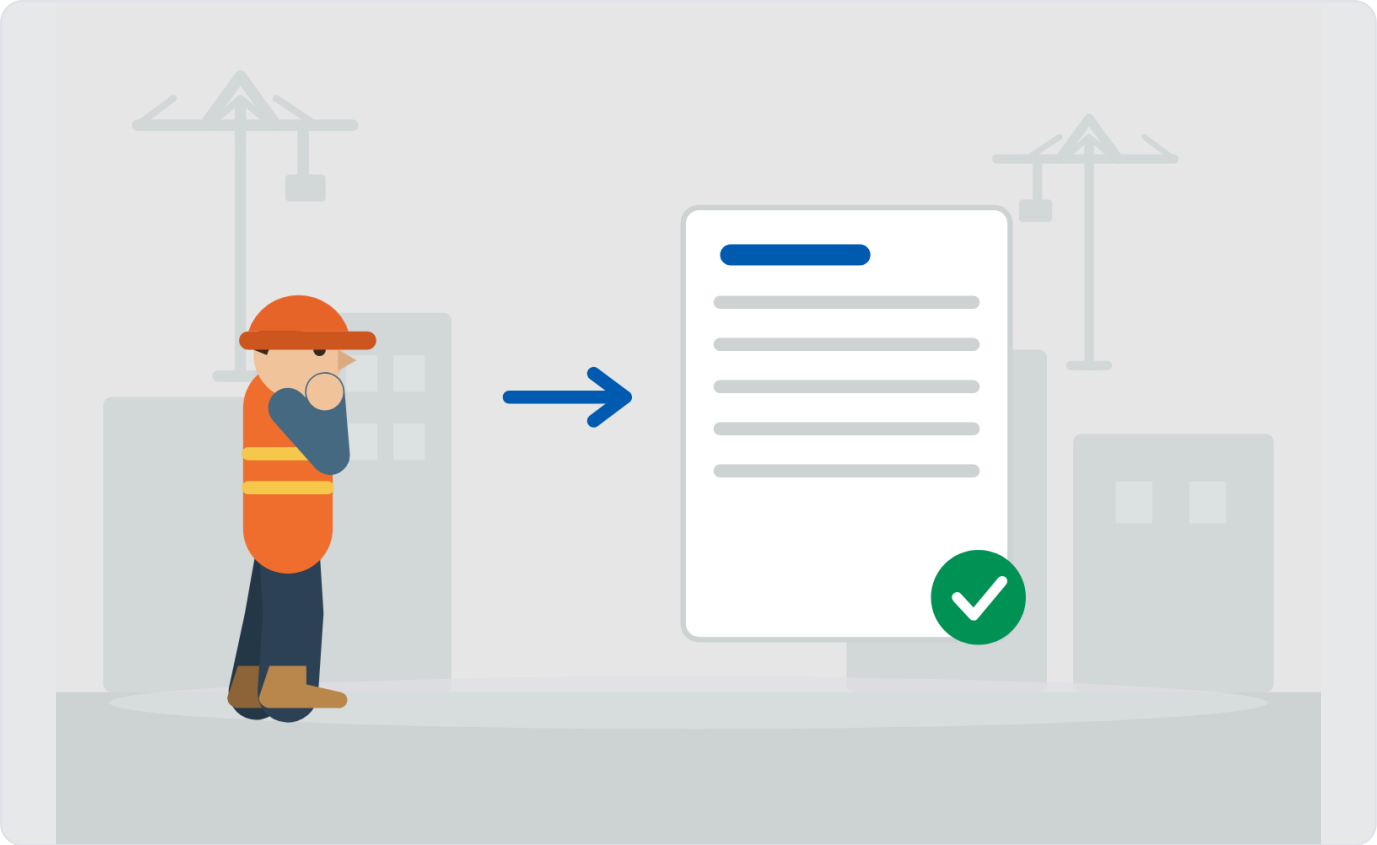
ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A sack truck, a pallet trolley and a hoist

11 Assess what is left

EMPLOYER & EMPLOYEE DUTIES

`11-assess-what-is-left.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Where handling cannot be avoided, assess it in writing.

COMPOSITION

A worker with hand to chin considering a task, an arrow, then an assessment form with a tick.

NOTES

Thinking pose must read as deliberate assessment, not confusion.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- A written manual handling risk assessment is required for handling that cannot be avoided.
- It has to consider the factors in Schedule 3 of the Regulations, which we cover in the next section.
- It should be reviewed when the job, the load, the place or the people change.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker considering a task beside an assessment form

12 Information and training

EMPLOYER & EMPLOYEE DUTIES

`12-information-and-training.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Training must be given by a competent person and be specific to the work.

COMPOSITION

A trainer facing two workers, with a TRAINING sign or banner above.

NOTES

Small group, informal, on site or in a site office — not a lecture theatre.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Employers must give employees information on the weight of loads and how to handle them safely.
- Employees who carry out manual handling must receive training from a person with the relevant training and experience.
- Training should be specific to the actual work, not generic, and refreshed when things change.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A trainer in front of two workers under a training sign

13 Your duties as an employee

EMPLOYER & EMPLOYEE DUTIES

`13-your-duties-as-an-employee.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Employee duties: follow the system, use the equipment, report problems.

COMPOSITION

A worker carrying a box correctly with a tick badge, and a chip reading FOLLOW THE SYSTEM.

NOTES

Positive framing: this is what good looks like.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Under the 2005 Act you must take reasonable care of your own safety and that of anyone affected by what you do.
- Follow the safe system of work, use the equipment provided, and use it the way you were trained to.
- Do not be under the influence of anything that puts you or others at risk, and do not interfere with or misuse safety equipment.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker carrying a load correctly, marked with a green tick

14 Report it

EMPLOYER & EMPLOYEE DUTIES

`14-report-it.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Report hazards, near misses and injuries straight away.

COMPOSITION

A worker and an arrow pointing to a report form. A chip: REPORT IT.

NOTES

Could also be a worker speaking to a supervisor with a tablet or paper form. Keep it neutral — nobody being told off.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Report anything that could injure someone: a blocked route, a broken trolley, a load heavier than expected, a near miss.
- Report injuries as soon as they happen, even minor ones. A small strain ignored is how long-term back trouble starts.
- Tell your employer if a health condition, an injury or a pregnancy affects what you can safely handle.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker filling in a report form

15 Looking after your back

EMPLOYER & EMPLOYEE DUTIES

`15-looking-after-your-back.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Warm up, change position, keep general fitness up.

COMPOSITION

One worker doing a gentle standing stretch, one standing relaxed, a tick badge between them.

NOTES

Gentle everyday movement. Not a gym, not exercise-class imagery.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Warm up gently before heavy work, and change position regularly through the day.
- Keep general fitness up and keep your weight within a healthy range for your height.
- If back pain starts, stop the activity and get it looked at rather than working through it.

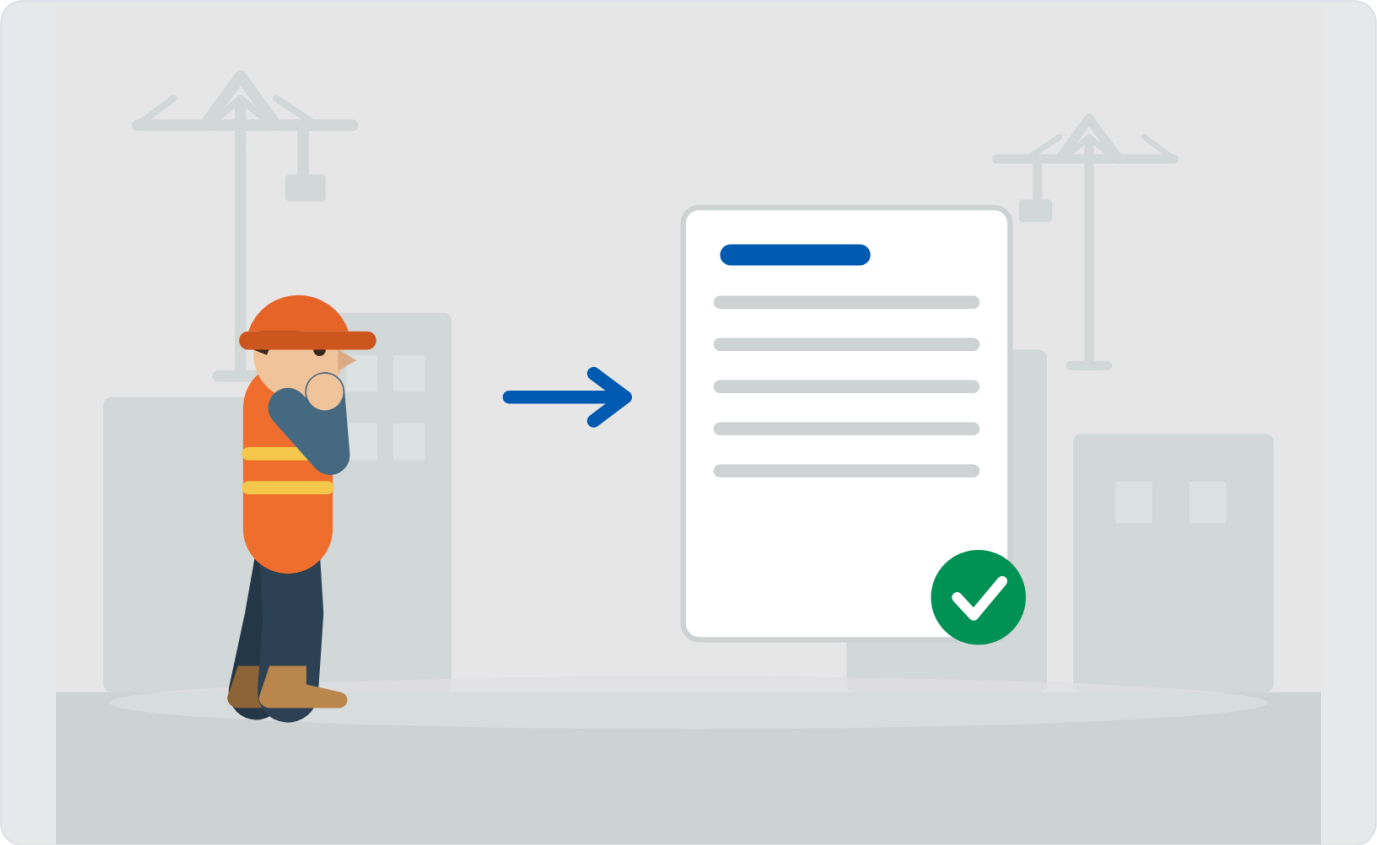
ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker stretching before work

16 What an assessment is for

RISK ASSESSMENT

`16-what-an-assessment-is-for.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

An assessment looks at the whole job, start to finish.

COMPOSITION

Same construction as slide 11: worker considering a task, arrow, form with a tick.

NOTES

Vary the camera or the task slightly from 11 so the two slides do not look identical.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- A manual handling risk assessment looks at the whole job, from where the load starts to where it ends up.
- Its purpose is to find the hazardous parts, decide who could be harmed, check what controls already exist, and decide what else is needed.
- The person carrying it out should know the Regulations, know the job, and be competent to do it.

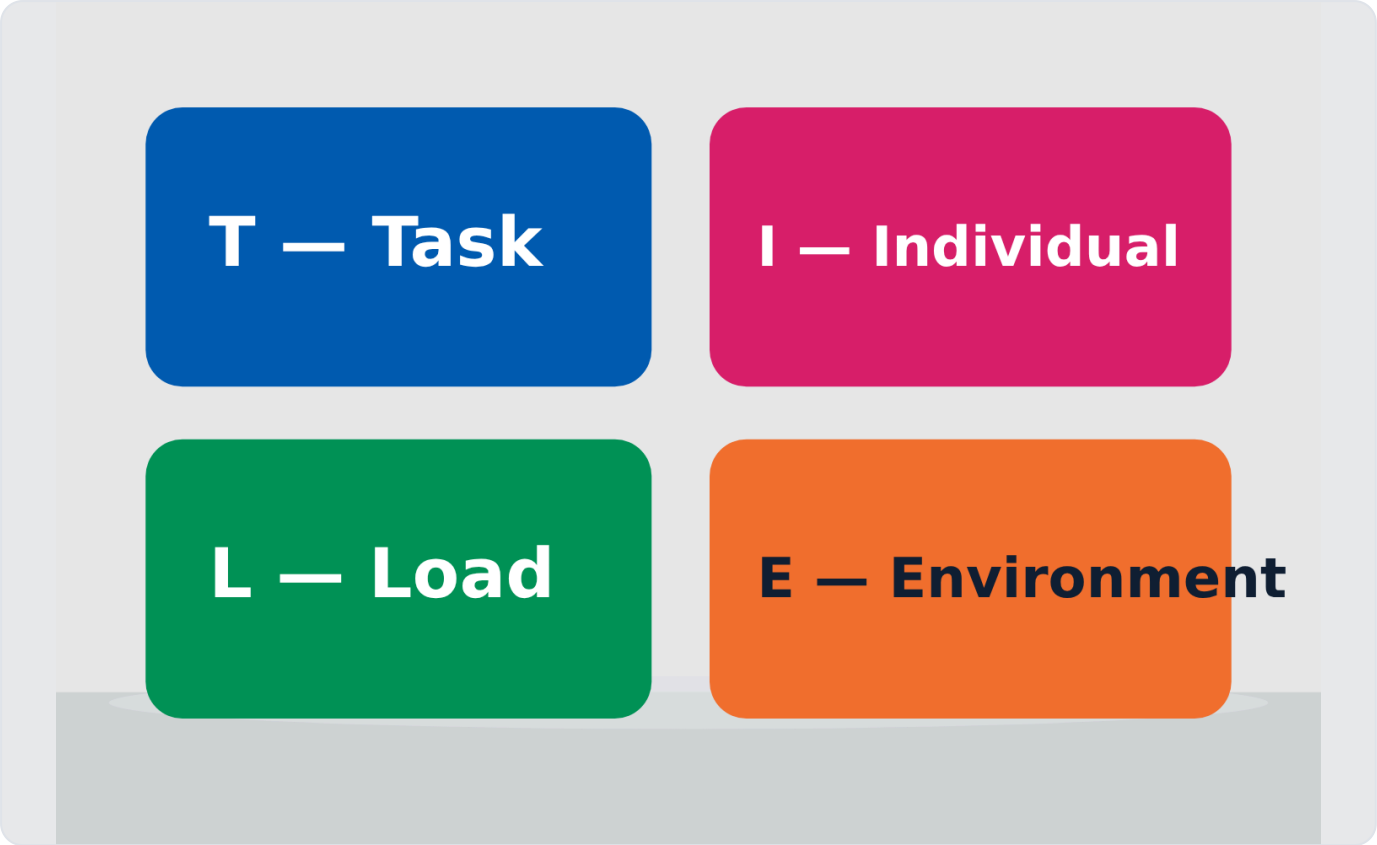
ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker studying a task beside an assessment form

17 TILE

RISK ASSESSMENT

`17-tile-overview.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

TILE: Task, Individual, Load, Environment.

COMPOSITION

Four coloured panels in a 2x2 grid, each with its letter and word: T — Task, I — Individual, L — Load, E — Environment.

NOTES

This one is typographic. Panel colours: blue, pink/ruby, green, orange. Text must stay inside each panel at small sizes.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- The Schedule 3 factors are easiest to remember as TILE.
- Task — what the handling actually involves. Individual — the person doing it. Load — what is being moved. Environment — where it happens.
- Run through all four before a lift you have not done before.

> **Task · Individual · Load · Environment**

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

Four coloured panels: Task, Individual, Load, Environment

18 T — Task

RISK ASSESSMENT

`18-t-for-task.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

The task: stooping, twisting, reaching, repetition.

COMPOSITION

Left: stooped lift with straight legs, red cross. Right: knees-bent lift with a straight back, green tick.

NOTES

This is the key technique comparison in the whole module. It must be anatomically believable — get a real lift photographed or posed for reference.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Does the task involve stooping, twisting, or reaching above shoulder height or below knee height?
- Is the load held away from the body, carried a long distance, or lifted and lowered repeatedly?
- Is there enough rest, and can the pace be set by the worker rather than by a machine or a delivery?

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A stooped lift marked with a cross beside a knees-bent lift marked with a tick

19 I — Individual

RISK ASSESSMENT

`19-i-for-individual.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

The person: training, fitness, particular risk, clothing and footwear.

COMPOSITION

One worker, front or three-quarter view, surrounded by four question chips: TRAINED? FIT FOR IT? FOOTWEAR? GLOVES?

NOTES

Keep the figure neutral. Do not depict the 'at-risk' examples (pregnancy, injury) as caricatures — leave the questions to the text.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Has the person been trained for this handling, and do they have the information they need?
- Does the job call for unusual strength, height or reach?
- Could it put someone at particular risk — a pregnant worker, a young worker, or someone with an existing injury or health condition?
- Does their clothing, footwear or PPE get in the way of a safe lift?

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker with labels asking about training, fitness, footwear and gloves

20 L — Load

RISK ASSESSMENT

`20-l-for-load.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

The load: weight, size, stability, handholds, contents that shift.

COMPOSITION

A large cardboard box, closed, labelled ?kg, with three chips around it: HEAVY, AWKWARD, UNSTABLE.

NOTES

The box should look genuinely awkward — slightly too big to get arms around.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Is it heavy, bulky or awkward to hold? There is no legal maximum weight in Ireland — it depends on the whole situation.
- Is the contents likely to shift, or is the load unstable or unpredictable?
- Are there handholds, or could packaging be changed to add some?
- Is it hot, cold, sharp, or hazardous if it spills?

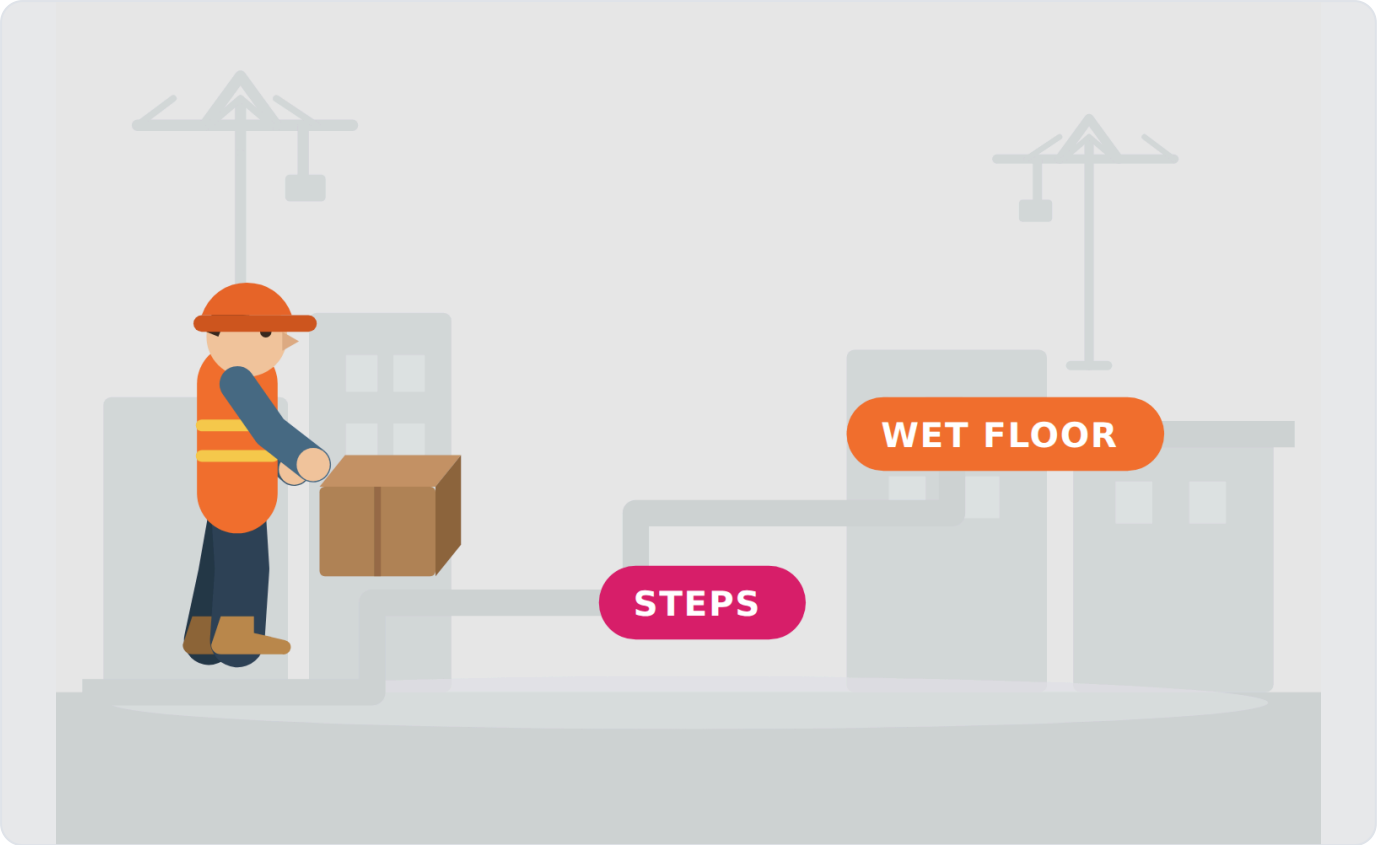
ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A box labelled heavy, awkward and unstable

21 E — Environment

RISK ASSESSMENT

`21-e-for-environment.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

The place: space, floor, level changes, lighting, weather.

COMPOSITION

A worker carrying a box along a route that rises in two steps. Chips: STEPS and WET FLOOR.

NOTES

Show the route as the hazard, not the worker. A wet-floor sheen or a cone would help.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Is there enough space to stand and move properly, and is the route clear?
- Are floors level, dry and in good condition, or are there steps, slopes and changes of surface?
- Is the lighting good enough to see the load and the route?
- Is it hot, cold, wet or windy? A gust can turn a sheet of ply into a sail.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A route with steps and level changes under bright sun

22 Other factors

RISK ASSESSMENT

`22-other-factors.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Equipment, maintenance, how the work is organised, PPE that gets in the way.

COMPOSITION

Same equipment line-up as slide 10 (sack truck, platform trolley, hoist).

NOTES

If budget allows, draw a second version with a maintenance tag on one trolley so it differs from slide 10.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- What equipment is available, is it maintained, and does everyone know how to use it?
- Does the way the work is organised force a rush — deliveries at the end of a shift, a single person doing a two-person job?
- Does PPE that is needed for another hazard make the handling harder, and how is that dealt with?

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

Handling aids: a sack truck, a pallet trolley and a hoist

23 Write it down and act on it

RISK ASSESSMENT

`23-write-it-down-and-act-on-it.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

A written assessment that is acted on, and reviewed when things change.

COMPOSITION

A completed assessment form with a tick, an arrow leading right, and a chip: ACT ON IT.

NOTES

The arrow out of the form is the whole point: paper to action.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- The assessment should be written down and kept with the safety documentation.
- Findings have to be acted on. An assessment that sits in a folder changes nothing on the ground.
- Review it when the load, the equipment, the place or the people change, or after an incident.

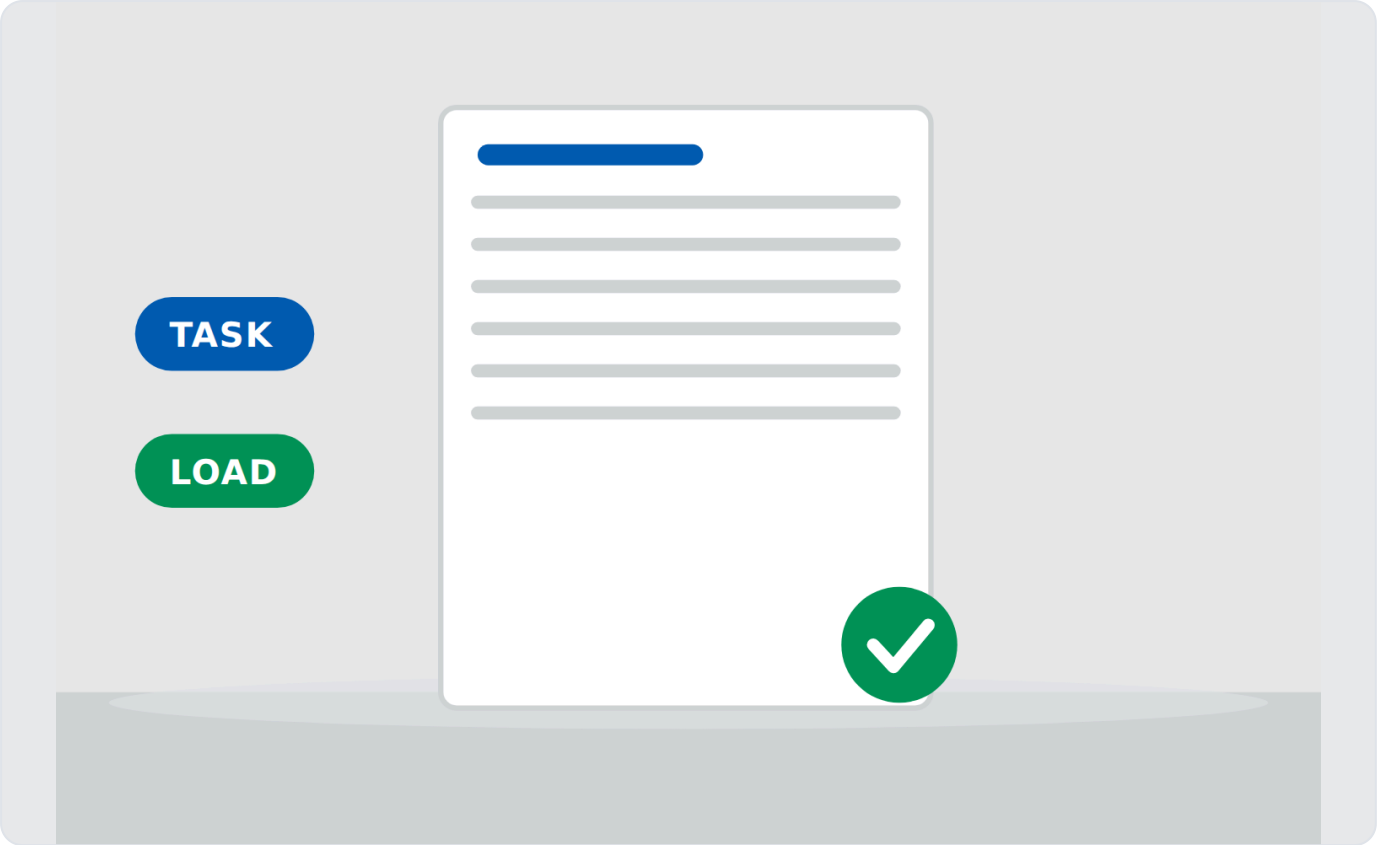
ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A completed assessment form with a tick and an arrow to action

24 Section summary

RISK ASSESSMENT

`24-summary-risk-assessment.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Wrap-up of section 3.

COMPOSITION

Checklist sheet with a tick badge, as slide 8.

NOTES

Differentiate from slide 8 with different chips or a different sheet angle.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Assess the whole job from start to finish, using TILE.
- There is no single safe weight limit: weight is only one factor among many.
- Record the assessment, act on it, and review it when things change.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A checklist with a tick

25 Think before you lift

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`25-think-before-you-lift.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Plan the lift before touching the load: route, weight, help, somewhere to put it.

COMPOSITION

A worker with hand to chin, a thought bubble containing a large question mark.

NOTES

The thought bubble may instead contain a tiny route plan — an arrow from A to B past an obstruction.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Where is it going, and is the route clear all the way?
- How heavy is it? Test it by tilting a corner before you commit.
- Do you need help, a trolley, or a different way of doing it altogether?
- Are there obstructions to move first, and somewhere ready to put the load down?

> **The lift starts before you touch the load.**

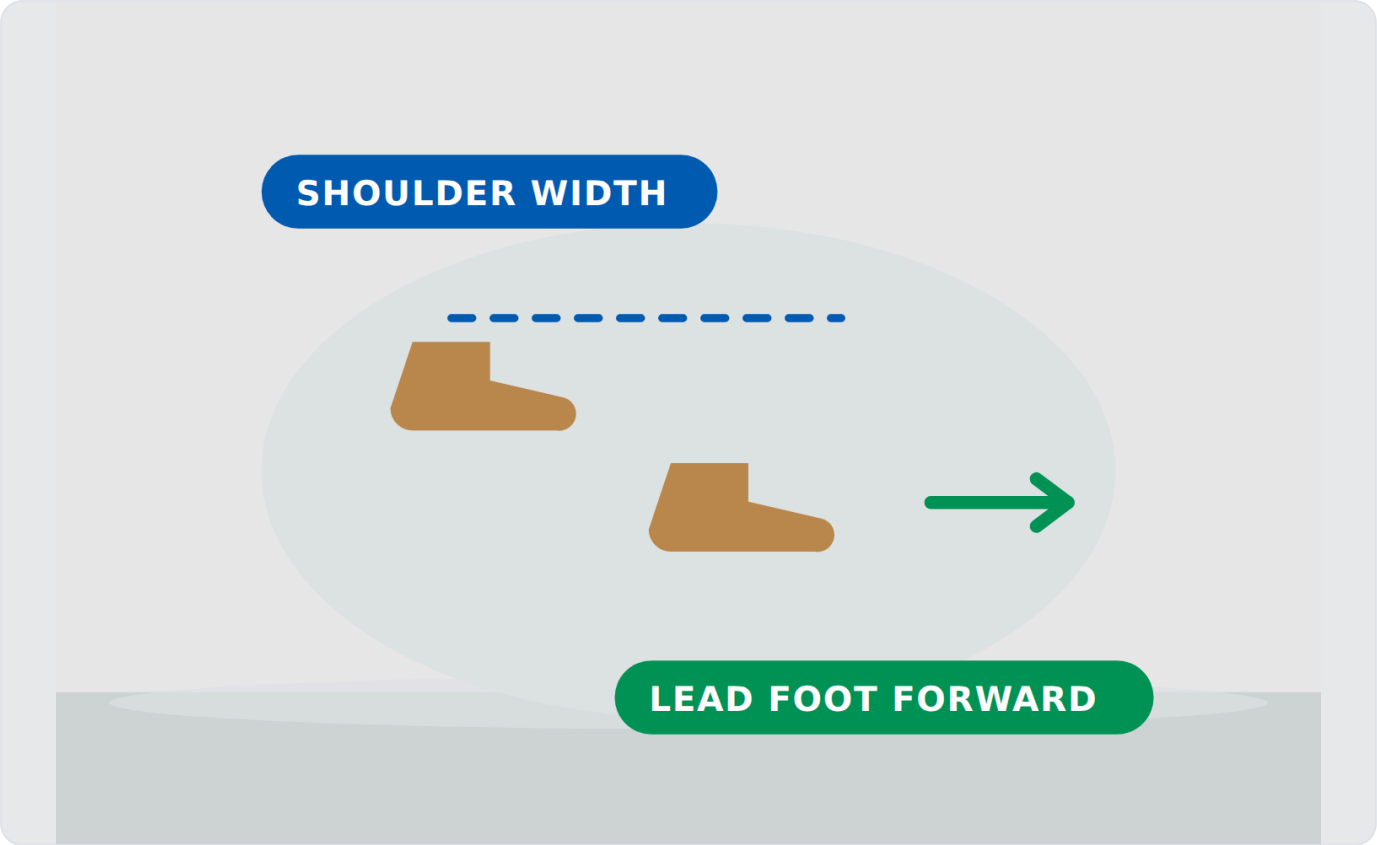
ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker planning a lift, with a question mark

26 Feet and stance

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`26-feet-and-stance.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Feet about shoulder width, leading foot forward, pointing the way you will travel.

COMPOSITION

Overhead or three-quarter view of two work boots on the ground, one slightly forward. A dashed width guide and a direction arrow. Chips: SHOULDER WIDTH, LEAD FOOT FORWARD.

NOTES

Feet only — no full figure. Boots must be real work boots with a visible sole.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Wear footwear suitable for the job and the ground.
- Put your feet roughly shoulder width apart for a stable base.
- Place the leading foot slightly forward, pointing the way you are going to travel.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

Overhead view of feet apart with the leading foot forward

27 Grip

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`27-grip.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Grip opposite corners, use handholds, keep arms inside the body line.

COMPOSITION

Close-up of a box with two hands on diagonally opposite corners. Tick badge. Chip: GRIP OPPOSITE CORNERS.

NOTES

Hands are the focus and must be well drawn — this is the most demanding close-up in the set.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Grip opposite corners rather than the sides — it is far more secure.
- Use handholds where they exist, and gloves where the load is sharp, rough or cold.
- Keep your arms within the boundary of your body rather than stretched out.
- If the grip is not secure, set it down and start again.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

Hands gripping opposite corners of a box

28 Posture

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`28-posture.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Bend the knees, keep the spine in natural alignment, get close to the load.

COMPOSITION

Same right/wrong pairing as slide 18.

NOTES

Draw a fresh pair rather than reusing 18, ideally from a slightly different angle so learners see the principle twice, not the same picture twice.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Bend your knees, not your back, and do not fully flex the knees into a deep squat.
- Keep your spine in its natural alignment, with the shoulders level and facing the same way as the hips.
- Get close to the load before you start. Reaching out multiplies the strain on your lower back.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A stooped lift marked with a cross beside a knees-bent lift marked with a tick

29 The lift

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`29-the-lift.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Smooth, progressive movement; lead with the head; power from the legs; load close.

COMPOSITION

Two-stage sequence in one frame: knees-bent start position on the left, an arrow, and the standing carry on the right. Tick badge.

NOTES

The two stages should be the same worker, same load, same camera — a before-and-after of one movement.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Keep relaxed. A smooth, progressive movement is safer than a snatch.
- Lead the movement with your head, and use the power of your legs.
- Keep the load close to your body, with the heaviest side nearest you.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker rising from a knees-bent position to a standing carry

30 Carrying

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`30-carrying.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Carry at waist height, close to the body, head up.

COMPOSITION

Left: load held close, tick. Right: same load held out at arm's length, cross.

NOTES

Exaggerate the difference in distance from the body, but keep both poses physically plausible.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Carry the load close to your waist, not out in front of you or on one hip.
- Keep your head up and look where you are going once the load is secure.
- Take shorter distances where you can, and put the load down and rest rather than struggling on.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A load carried close to the body, and the same load held out in front marked with a cross

31 Turning

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`31-turning.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Never twist under load; move the feet so hips and shoulders stay in line.

COMPOSITION

A worker carrying a box, with a curved dashed arc on the ground showing the feet stepping round. Chips: MOVE THE FEET, DO NOT TWIST.

NOTES

Hard to draw well. Consider two small figures: one twisting at the waist (cross), one stepping round (tick).

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Never twist your trunk while holding a load. Twisting under load is one of the most common ways backs are injured.
- Move your feet to turn, so hips and shoulders stay in line.
- Plan the turn before you lift, so you are not correcting it halfway.

> **Turn with your feet, not your spine.**

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker turning by moving their feet rather than twisting

32 Setting down

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`32-setting-down.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Lower with bent knees; put it down first, then slide it into position.

COMPOSITION

A worker lowering a box with knees bent, and an arrow showing the box being slid after it is down. Chip: THEN ADJUST.

NOTES

Show the box resting on a surface before the slide, not mid-air.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Lower the load the way you lifted it: knees bent, back in line, load close.
- Put it down first, then slide it into position. Do not adjust it in mid-air.
- Watch your fingers and toes, and make sure it is stable before you let go.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker lowering a box with bent knees, then sliding it into place

33 High and low loads

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`33-high-and-low-loads.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Avoid lifting above shoulder height; use steps; store heavy items between knee and shoulder.

COMPOSITION

A worker on a small set of steps or a platform reaching a box on a shelf at a comfortable height. Chip: USE STEPS.

NOTES

The steps must look stable and appropriate — a proper step-up, never a chair, bucket or pallet.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Avoid lifting above shoulder height. Use steps or a platform so the load starts at a better height.
- For loads on the ground, bring them to bench height first where you can.
- Store heavy items between knee and shoulder height so they never need a bad lift.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker using steps to reach a high shelf

34 Team handling

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`34-team-handling.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Team lift for long or awkward loads; one person calls it.

COMPOSITION

Two workers carrying a long board or beam between them, in step. Chip: ONE PERSON CALLS IT.

NOTES

Both should hold at the same height. Show the caller looking towards their partner.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Use a team lift for long, heavy or awkward loads, and match people of roughly similar height where possible.
- One person calls the lift, and everyone knows the plan and the route before it starts.
- Lift, move and lower together on the call.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

Two workers carrying a long load together

35 Pushing and pulling

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`35-pushing-and-pulling.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Push rather than pull; back straight; use legs and body weight; loads low.

COMPOSITION

A worker pushing a loaded sack truck, leaning into it, with a direction arrow. Chip: PUSH, NOT PULL.

NOTES

Load stacked low on the truck. Back straight, not hunched over the handles.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- Push rather than pull where you can: you can see where you are going and your back is better supported.
- Keep your back straight, and push with your legs and body weight rather than your arms alone.
- Keep loads low on the trolley, check the wheels run freely, and slow down on slopes and ramps.

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker pushing a loaded trolley

36 If it hurts, stop

HANDLING TECHNIQUES

`36-if-it-hurts-stop.jpg`



Current code-drawn version — reference only

WHAT THE SLIDE TEACHES

Stop, report it, get it looked at.

COMPOSITION

A worker with a hand to the lower back beside a large stop sign. Chip: STOP AND REPORT.

NOTES

Final slide of the module. Serious but not bleak; the message is 'speak up early', not 'you are finished'.

TEXT ON THE SLIDE (NOT IN THE IMAGE)

- If you feel pain during a lift, stop straight away. Do not try to finish it.
- Report it to your supervisor and follow your site procedure for injuries and near misses.
- Get medical advice. Early treatment is what keeps a strain from becoming a long-term problem.

> **This module is guidance only. Practical, instructor-led training is still required.**

ALT TEXT TO MATCH

A worker in pain beside a stop sign